

GUANGZHI CHEN

Warrington College of Business
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EDUCATION

University of Florida	2021–2027 (Expected)
• Ph.D. in Marketing (Quantitative)	
Hunan University	2017–2020
• M.S. in Applied Economics	
Hefei University of Technology	2013–2017
• B.S. in Business Administration	

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Online Platform, Digital Marketing, Economics of AI, Applied Game Theory, Empirical Modeling

RESEARCH

Working Papers

- Guangzhi Chen, Zheyin (Jane) Gu, and Tianxin Zou, “Product Discoverability in E-Commerce Marketplaces with Seller External Advertising”
 - Job Market Paper**
 - Major revision at *Journal of Marketing Research*
- Guangzhi Chen and Zheyin (Jane) Gu, “Facilitating Progression, Preserving Gameplay: Booster Design in Video Games”
 - In preparation for submission to *Journal of Marketing Research*
 - Accepted for presentation at Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST) 2026

Publications

- Guangzhi Chen and Tianxin Zou (2026). Personalized Pricing with Consumers’ Quality Uncertainty. *Production and Operations Management*, 0(0). (<https://doi.org/10.1177/10591478261465977>)
- Erbao Cao and Guangzhi Chen (2021). Information Sharing Motivated by Production Cost Reduction in a Supply Chain with Downstream Competition. *Naval Research Logistics (NRL)*, 68(7), 898–907.

Work in Progress

- Guangzhi Chen, Baojun Jiang, and Tianxin Zou, “AI-Generated Summary of Consumer Reviews”
- Guangzhi Chen and Zheyin (Jane) Gu, “AI Shopping Assistants and Product Recommendations”

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

“Personalized Pricing with Consumers’ Quality Uncertainty”

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| • 2023 Southeast Marketing Symposium | April 2023 |
| • 33rd POMS Annual Conference | May 2023 |

“Product Discoverability in E-Commerce Marketplaces with Seller External Advertising”

- University of Houston’s 42nd Annual Doctoral Symposium April 2025
- 35th POMS Annual Conference May 2025
- 2025 ISMS Marketing Science Conference June 2025
- 56th Annual Conference of the Decision Sciences Institute November 2025

“Facilitating Progression, Preserving Gameplay: Booster Design in Video Games”

- 36th POMS Annual Conference May 2026
- Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST) 2026 October 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Interests: Marketing Analytics, AI/ML in Marketing, Digital Marketing, Marketing Strategy

Instructor

- Marketing Management (Undergraduate), University of Florida Spring 2024
 - Evaluation: 4.26/5 (above college mean)

Teaching Assistant

- Art and Science of Pricing (Master’s), University of Florida Fall 2021

SELECTED DOCTORAL COURSEWORK

Marketing: Marketing Decision Models, Multivariate Methods, Perspectives on Consumer Behavior

Economics: Microeconomic Theory, Mathematical Economics, Game Theory, Information Economics

Statistics and Machine Learning: Regression Analysis, Theoretical Statistics, Statistical Computing, Machine Learning and Python, Machine Learning in Business, Causal Machine Learning

PROGRAMMING SKILLS AND TOOLS

Python, R, Stata, Mathematica, MATLAB, L^AT_EX, Large Language Models (LLMs), Claude Code, Codex

HONORS AND AWARDS

ISMS Marketing Science Doctoral Consortium Fellow	2025
AMA Sheth Foundation Doctoral Consortium Fellow	2024
Doctoral Fellowship, University of Florida	2021–2027
First Prize Scholarship, Hunan University	2017–2020
Graduation with Great Distinction in Anhui Province	2017
China National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China	2013–2016
First Prize Scholarship, Hefei University of Technology	2013–2016

REFERENCES

Tianxin Zou

Assistant Professor of Marketing
Warrington College of Business
University of Florida
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Zheyin (Jane) Gu

Professor of Marketing
School of Business
University of Connecticut
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Xiajun (Amy) Pan

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Systems and Operations Management
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“Product Discoverability in E-Commerce Marketplaces with Seller External Advertising”

with Zheyin (Jane) Gu and Tianxin Zou (JMP, major revision at *Journal of Marketing Research*)

This paper examines how an e-commerce marketplace should design product discovery tools, which help consumers find products on the platform, accounting for sellers potentially advertising on external channels (e.g., search engines and social media) to attract consumers to the marketplace. Our paper’s central finding is that the platform can profit from *strategically limiting* product discovery because of two distinct mechanisms: (1) a *traffic-expansion* mechanism, where limiting discovery mitigates advertising leakage and encourages sellers to advertise, expanding total platform traffic; (2) a *differentiation* mechanism, where limiting discovery induces some but not all sellers to advertise, creating differentiation in consumer awareness among sellers and thus softening price competition. We also show that the platform’s optimal discoverability level changes non-monotonically with different market parameters, such as how substitutable competing products are and how costly or effective external advertising is. The strategic interactions of the platform and sellers further yield counterintuitive welfare consequences: when products are stronger substitutes, despite more intense price competition, sellers’ profit can increase while consumer surplus can decrease; and when sellers’ external advertising becomes less costly or more effective in attracting consumers, both sellers and consumers can be worse off.

“Personalized Pricing with Consumers’ Quality Uncertainty”

with Tianxin Zou (Published at *Production and Operations Management*)

We examine a firm’s personalized pricing (PP) strategies in markets where consumers are uncertain about product quality. In such markets, prices serve not only as a tool for price discrimination but also as a means of conveying quality information to consumers. We reveal that a firm faces a tradeoff between adopting PP to better price discriminate among consumers and not adopting it to signal its high quality. We find that a high-quality firm should adopt PP only when its product quality is known to either a very small or a very large fraction of consumers, and when its high-quality product, on average, offers either very low or very high additional value to consumers relative to a low-quality product. Moreover, the high-quality firm may charge consumers personalized prices less than their willingness to pay to signal its quality in equilibrium, deviating from first-degree price discrimination when consumers are informed about quality. Counterintuitively, when more consumers know product quality or when the high-quality product provides higher average value to consumers, consumer surplus and social welfare may decrease, but a low-quality firm’s profit may increase. Furthermore, the firm’s profit can be lower when its personalized pricing leverages more information about consumer characteristics. Randomized experiments provide evidence that a personalized price is a weaker signal of objective product quality than a uniform price.

“Facilitating Progression, Preserving Gameplay: Booster Design in Video Games”

with Zheyin (Jane) Gu (In preparation for submission to *Journal of Marketing Research*)

In single-player video games, developers often provide players with boosters, or consumable tools that can reduce their effort to clear a level, to sustain progression. Meanwhile, players’ lower-level play can facilitate their understanding of game design and structure, contributing to improved performance and enjoyment at a more advanced level. We study the developer’s optimal booster design, accounting for its impact on a player’s endogenous gameplay decisions. First, we show that a more powerful booster, when not too powerful, can motivate the player to extend gameplay at both the lower and advanced levels. This motivating impact is stronger under more efficient carryover of gameplay experience across levels. However, if the booster is already powerful, further enhancing its power discourages gameplay at both levels. Second, a developer that maximizes monetization opportunities from players’ gameplay time should offer a booster of moderate power. However, a strong tendency to profit from booster sales induces the developer to increase booster power, causing a reduction in players’ playtime. Third, the optimal booster power and price vary with player characteristics, suggesting the benefits of booster customization. Interestingly, the developer may offer a less powerful booster at a higher price to players perceiving a higher progression reward.